IA

Inventory Analyzer

READ-ONLY FOLDER AND FILE INVENTORY

QUICK START

Quick Start

From a folder to a downloaded inventory report in five steps

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Audience New users

Document control

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Version history

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	First release: read-only folder scan, dashboard, inventory, storage analysis, optional duplicates, Excel and CSV exports, scan history
1.1	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	Folder Explorer, Where your files are, Show in folder tree, Folder Tree sheet
1.2	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	Reopen saved scans and download their reports; seven numbered guides inside the app

Related documents

ID	Document
IA-UG-01	User Guide
IA-IG-02	Installation and Administration Guide
IA-FAQ-04	FAQ and Troubleshooting
IA-TD-05	Technical Design
IA-UAT-06	UAT Test Cases
IA-RN-07	Release Notes v1.2

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1 Quick start

This card takes you from a folder on your PC to a downloaded Excel inventory in five steps. Full details for every screen are in the User Guide (IA-UG-01).

> **Three rules**
>
> **Read-only:** your files are never created, changed, moved, renamed or deleted. **Nothing leaves your PC:** the scan runs in your browser and nothing is uploaded. **No guessing:** anything that could not be read is shown as unknown or unverified, never as empty or duplicate.

1.1 Before you start

You need	Example
The app: the desktop launcher, the HTML file, or the shared link	Double-click `Start Inventory Analyzer.bat`
Microsoft Edge or Google Chrome (Firefox and Safari work with **Upload a folder** only)	Edge on Windows 11
Read access to the folder you want to inventory	`S:\Shared Drive` or `C:\Users\you\Documents\Projects`

1.2 The five steps

Step	Screen	What you do	Takes
1	New Scan	Keep the default options. Tick **Detect duplicate files** only if you want to find identical copies.	10 sec
2	New Scan	Click **Choose folder...**, pick the folder and confirm **View files**. (Firefox, Safari, or if the picker is blocked: **Upload a folder...**)	10 sec
3	Scan progress	Wait. A few thousand files take seconds. **Cancel scan** keeps what was found so far.	sec to min
4	Dashboard	Read the totals and key findings. **Where your files are** shows the files per top-level folder; click one to open it in the **Folder Explorer**. If there is a yellow message, open **Scan Errors**.	2 min+
5	Any results screen	Click **Excel (.xlsx)** (or **All CSVs (.zip)**). The file goes to your Downloads folder.	10 sec

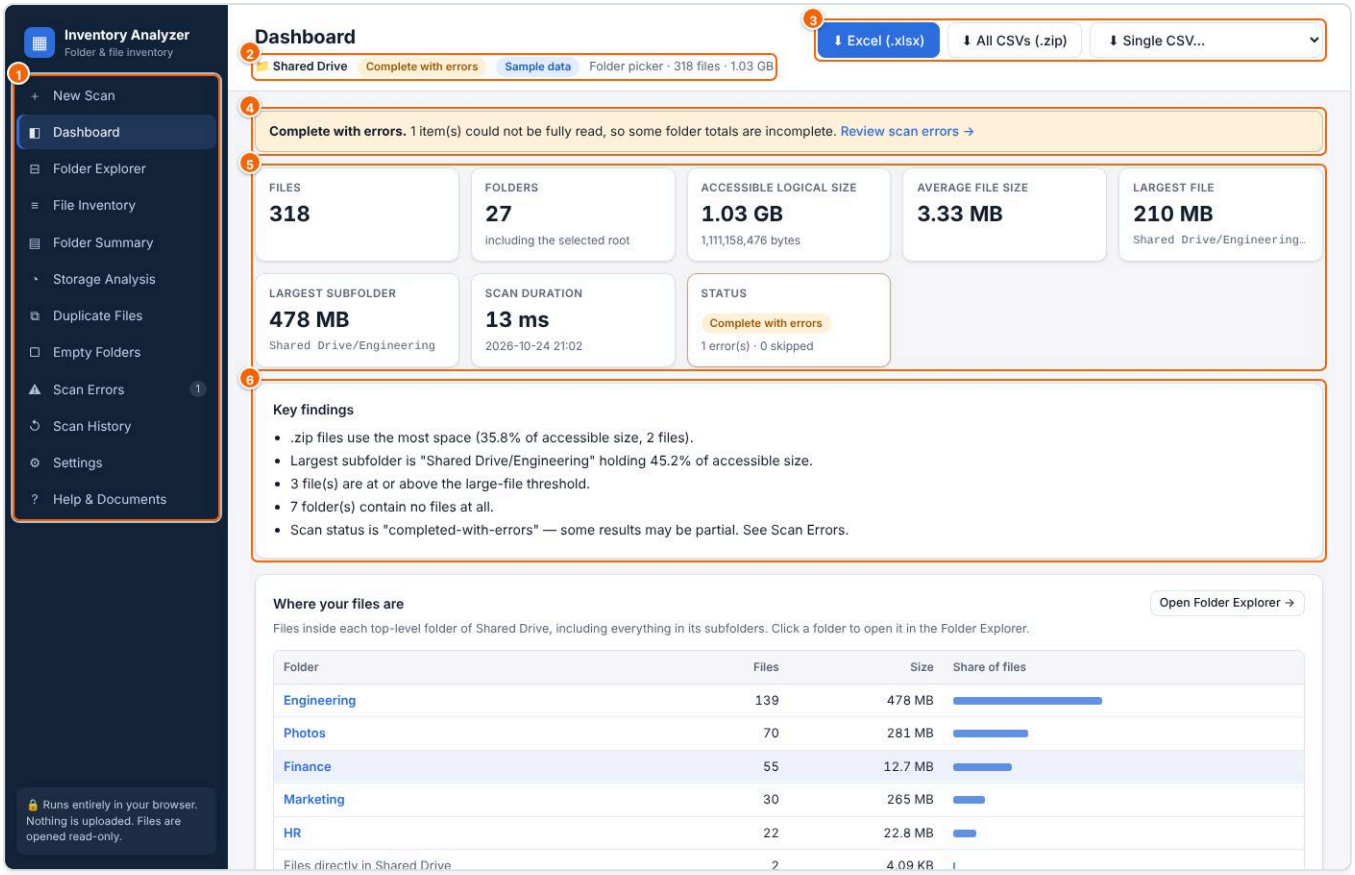


Figure 1: The dashboard tells you what is in the folder and where the space goes

1.3 Default options

Option	Default	When to change
Include dot-prefixed items	On	You want to leave out `.git`, `.cache` and similar folders
Detect duplicate files (SHA-256)	Off	You want to find identical copies (slower; reads file contents locally)
Large-file threshold	100 MB	You care about smaller or larger "large" files
Top-N report size	25	You want longer or shorter "largest" lists
Keep full results of past scans (Settings)	On	You do not want file names kept in this browser

1.4 Where to find answers

Question	Screen
Which folder has how many files?	**Folder Explorer** (tree with "files here" and "in total"), or **Folder Summary**
Where is a particular file?	**Folder Explorer**: type part of its name; or **File Inventory**: search, then 📍
What takes up the space?	**Dashboard** charts, **Storage Analysis**
Are there duplicate copies?	**Duplicate Files** (scan with duplicate detection on)

Question	Screen
Which folders are empty?	**Empty Folders**
What could not be read?	**Scan Errors**
Can I get last week's report again?	**Scan History**: **Open**, **Excel** or **CSVs**

1.5 What the statuses mean

Status	Meaning	Your action
Complete	Everything was read	None
Complete with errors	Some items could not be read	Open **Scan Errors**; totals of folders marked incomplete may be low
Cancelled — partial	You stopped the scan	Scan again for full results
Failed	The scan could not run	Read the message and scan again
unknown (folder)	The folder could not be opened	See Scan Errors; it is never counted as empty
unverified (file)	The file could not be compared for duplicates	Usually none; raise the hashing limit in Settings if it is a very large file

1.6 Try it safely first

1. On **New Scan** click **Try with sample data**.
2. You should see 318 files, 27 folders, 1.03 GB and **Complete with errors** (one folder refuses access on purpose).
3. Open **Folder Explorer** and type `contract`: two files, in two different folders.
4. Click **Excel (.xlsx)** and open the workbook.

> **Where to get help**
>
> In the app: **Help & Documents** in the menu. Installing or sharing the app: Installation and Administration Guide (IA-IG-02). Error messages and common questions: FAQ and Troubleshooting (IA-FAQ-04).